

Logistics Market Intelligence Report Ocean

Monthly Report | Aug 2026

SAMSUNG SDS

A large container ship is shown sailing on the ocean, viewed from an elevated angle. The ship is heavily loaded with blue and white shipping containers. The ship's white hull and superstructure are visible against the dark blue water. The image is partially obscured by a large, curved, teal-colored graphic element that sweeps across the bottom left and right corners of the page.



Contents

- 1. Executive Summary 1**
- 2. Container Market 2**
 - Global Container Trade.....2
 - Container Import Volume at Major US ports.....2
 - Global Containership Fleet3
 - Regional Containership Deployment Shifts.....3
 - Schedule Reliability & Port Congestion.....4
- 3. Ocean Freight Index Trends & Outlook 5**
 - SCFI Trends.....5
 - Samsung SDS Short-term Forecast5





1. Executive Summary

Demand

- 2026 global container trade is projected to grow 3.7% YoY. Exports from China to Europe and emerging markets will support growth, but the pace is expected to slow YoY amid Middle East trade disruptions.
- Q3 2026 Asia-North America trade is projected to decline 0.7% YoY. While front-loading effects are fading, an extended peak season amid uncertainty over additional US tariffs may provide some support to demand.
- Q3 2026 Asia-Europe trade is projected to grow 1.3% YoY. Growth is expected to slow sharply YoY as peak-season volumes ease and European consumption weakens.

Supply

- 2026 global containership supply is projected to grow 4.6% YoY, outpacing demand growth. Supply pressure will persist, but actual capacity growth will be limited by capacity absorption from Red Sea and Hormuz diversions.
- Newbuild deliveries are projected at 1.6m TEU in 2026, down YoY but remaining high. Large-scale newbuild inflows from 2027 onward are expected to add medium- to long-term supply pressure.
- Red Sea diversions and uncertainty over Hormuz transit are constraining effective capacity. With capacity remaining tight, near-term availability will depend on carriers' capacity management.

Freight Index

- The SCFI Comprehensive Index rose 5.1% MoM in July, rebounding from late July led by the Americas and Middle East. US GRIs and Middle East risks are expected to support rates from August, though weakness in Europe and the Mediterranean may limit further gains.
- July USWC and USEC rates rose 13.4% and 26.7% MoM, respectively. US GRIs and China-origin schedule disruptions are expected to support rates from August. USWC may readjust if demand weakens, while USEC rates may remain higher for longer due to capacity management and Panama operational risks.
- July N. Europe and Mediterranean rates rose 6.2% and 5.3% MoM, respectively, but have declined since early July. Further corrections are expected from August as peak-season volumes ease and new capacity enters, though capacity management may limit the pace of decline.
- July Middle East rates fell 4.8% MoM but have strengthened for four consecutive weeks. High volatility is expected to persist from August amid continued Hormuz tensions, higher cost burdens and supply constraints.

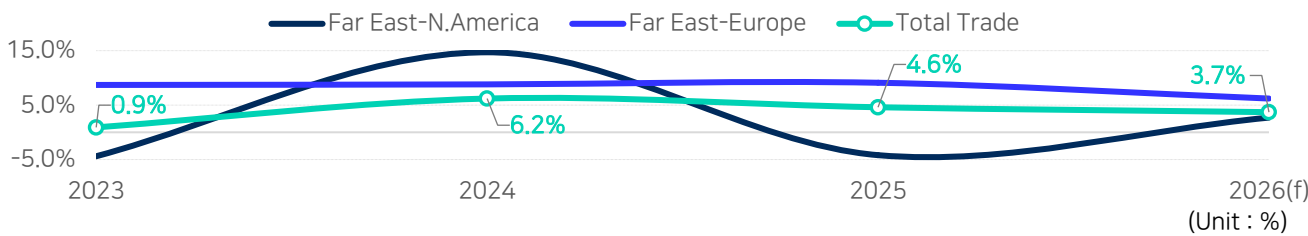


2. Container Market

Global Container Trade

- 2026 global container trade is projected to grow 3.7% YoY. Exports from China to Europe, Asia and emerging markets will support growth, while Middle East trade disruptions may offset gains and widen regional divergence.
- Q3 2026 Asia-North America trade is projected to decline 0.7% YoY. While front-loading effects are fading, an extended peak season amid uncertainty over additional US tariffs may provide some support to Q3 demand.
- Q3 2026 Asia-Europe trade is projected to grow 1.3% YoY. Growth is expected to slow sharply from Q2 as peak-season volumes ease following concentrated China-origin exports in H1 and European consumption recovery remains limited.

[Global Container Trade Growth Trend(YoY)]¹

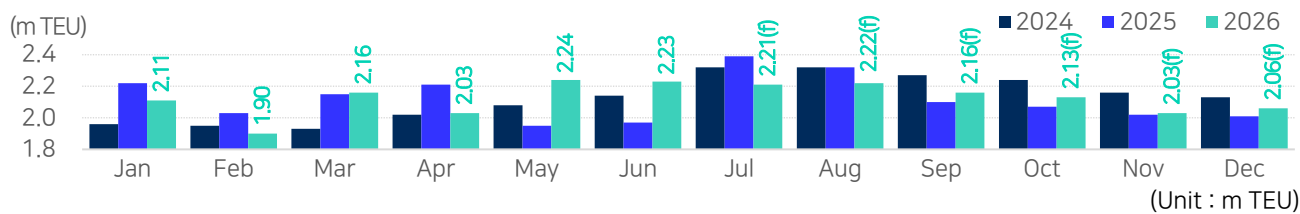


Trade Route	2023	2024	2025					2026(f)			
				Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4		Q1	Q2	Q3
Far East-N.America	-4.4%	14.7%	-4.2%	7.2%	-8.6%	-7.6%	-6.0%	2.7%	-3.4%	13.3%	-0.7%
Far East-Europe	8.7%	8.8%	9.1%	9.1%	8.4%	12.3%	6.6%	6.2%	15.0%	9.9%	1.3%
Global Trade	0.9%	6.2%	4.6%	-	-	-	-	3.7%	-	-	-

Container Import Volume at Major US ports

- July 2026 imports are projected at 2.21m TEU. Peak-season demand brought forward since May in response to tariff changes and supply chain uncertainty is expected to continue.
- August imports are projected at 2.22m TEU, up 0.5% MoM. Front-loading demand is expected to persist longer than anticipated amid concerns over additional US tariffs, keeping imports elevated through August.
- Imports are expected to decline gradually from September through year-end. Full-year US imports are projected at 25.48m TEU, up about 0.2% YoY, supported by front-loading since H1.

[Container Import Volume at Major US ports]²



Year	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
2024	1.96	1.95	1.93	2.02	2.08	2.14	2.32	2.32	2.27	2.24	2.16	2.13	25.52
2025	2.22	2.03	2.15	2.21	1.95	1.97	2.39	2.32	2.10	2.07	2.02	2.01	25.44
2026	2.11	1.90	2.16	2.03	2.24	2.23	2.21(f)	2.22(f)	2.16(f)	2.13(f)	2.03(f)	2.06(f)	25.48(f)

¹ Clarksons

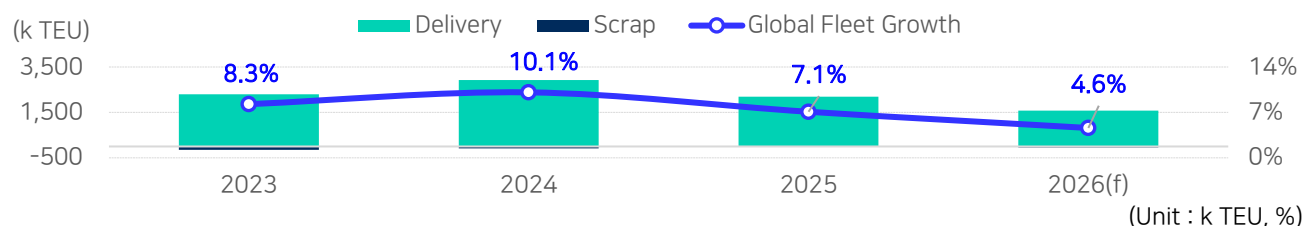
² NRF



Global Containership Fleet

- The global containership fleet is projected at 34.6m TEU in 2026, up 4.6% YoY. Capacity growth will continue to outpace demand, but actual supply availability will remain constrained by Red Sea and Hormuz diversions.
- Newbuild deliveries are projected at 1.6m TEU in 2026, down YoY but remaining high. Large-scale orderbook deliveries from 2027 onward are expected to add medium- to long-term supply pressure.
- Red Sea diversions and uncertainty over Hormuz transit are constraining effective capacity and keeping supply tight. Near-term availability will depend on carriers' capacity management.

[Global Containership Fleet Supply]³



Container Supply	2023		2024		2025		2026(f)	
		%YoY		%YoY		%YoY		%YoY
Global Fleet Growth	28,000	8.3%	30,900	10.1%	33,100	7.1%	34,600	4.6%
Delivery	2,298	124.8%	2,923	27.2%	2,192	-25.0%	1,579	-28.0%
Scrap	150	924.0%	83	-44.3%	5	-93.6%	45	739.0%

Regional Containership Deployment Shifts

- Asia-USWC vessel deployment rose 5.8% MoM to 128 vessels in July and is projected to rise 3.1% to 132 in August. However, tighter capacity management may limit actual capacity growth despite higher vessel deployment.
- Asia-USEC deployment fell 8.6% MoM to 64 vessels in July, then is projected to rise 10.9% to 71 in August. Capacity management and concerns over Panama Canal draft restrictions may limit actual capacity growth relative to vessel deployment.
- Asia-N. Europe deployment rose 7.6% MoM to 99 vessels in July and is projected to rise 2.0% to 101 in August. Slowing peak-season demand is expected to moderate further capacity additions.
- Asia-Mediterranean deployment fell 3.9% MoM to 123 vessels in July and is projected to decline another 0.8% to 122 in August. Carriers are expected to continue reducing deployed capacity as peak-season demand slows.
- Asia-Middle East deployment fell 8.6% MoM to 64 vessels in July and is expected to remain unchanged in August amid continued transit disruptions from Hormuz uncertainty.

[Regional Containership Deployment Shifts]⁴

(Unit : Vessel, %)

Year	Month	Far East-USWC		Far East-USEC		Far East-N.Europe		Far East-Med		Far East-ECSA		Far East-ME	
			%MoM		%MoM		%MoM		%MoM		%MoM		%MoM
2026	Jan	104	-11.1%	56	-6.7%	95	-2.1%	118	0.9%	34	-5.6%	89	17.1%
	Feb	107	2.9%	62	10.7%	88	-7.4%	108	-8.5%	33	-2.9%	82	-7.9%
	Mar	115	7.5%	59	-4.8%	82	-6.8%	110	1.9%	35	6.1%	70	-14.6%
	Apr	115	0.0%	63	6.8%	94	14.6%	125	13.6%	34	-2.9%	89	27.1%
	May	116	0.9%	62	-1.6%	92	-2.1%	127	1.6%	33	-2.9%	80	-10.1%
	Jun	121	4.3%	70	12.9%	92	0.0%	128	0.8%	34	3.0%	70	-12.5%
	Jul	128	5.8%	64	-8.6%	99	7.6%	123	-3.9%	40	17.6%	64	-8.6%
	Aug(f)	132	3.1%	71	10.9%	101	2.0%	122	-0.8%	37	-7.5%	64	0.0%

³ Clarksons

⁴ Samsung SDS Brightics



Schedule Reliability & Port Congestion

- Global schedule reliability fell 1.9%p MoM to 62.6% in June, partially reversing May's improvement.
- Asia-USWC schedule reliability edged up 0.2%p MoM to 72.7% in June, over 10%p above the global average and remaining the most stable among major routes.
- Asia-USEC schedule reliability improved 3.0%p MoM to 70.0% in June, marking a third consecutive monthly gain and exceeding the global average by over 7%p.
- Asia-N. Europe schedule reliability improved 0.6%p MoM to 68.6% in June. Gains slowed after May's sharp improvement, but reliability remained above the global average.

[Schedule Reliability]⁵

(Unit : %, %p)

Route	26-Apr		26-May		26-Jun	
		%MoM		%MoM		%MoM
Far East-USWC	72.4%	4.8%p	72.5%	0.1%p	72.7%	0.2%p
Far East-USEC	62.6%	3.1%p	67.0%	4.4%p	70.0%	3.0%p
Far East-N.Europe	57.2%	3.5%p	68.0%	10.8%p	68.6%	0.6%p
Global	62.2%	0.2%p	64.5%	2.3%p	62.6%	-1.9%p

- Long Beach congestion rose 32.5% WoW to 25.3 vessels in W32, rebounding as vessel queues increased after a temporary decline in W31.
- New York congestion fell 2.4% WoW to 12.3 vessels in W32. The overall downtrend since W25 continued, with congestion remaining relatively stable.
- Rotterdam congestion eased sharply from its W27 peak to 55.3 vessels in W32. Congestion declined for three consecutive weeks from W30 but remained elevated above 50 vessels.
- Hamburg congestion rose 8.7% WoW to 40.1 vessels in W32, continuing to fluctuate between 37 and 41 vessels over the past eight weeks.
- Shanghai congestion plunged 29.2% WoW to 154.1 vessels in W32. Congestion driven by late-July shipment concentration and typhoons eased temporarily, but may rise again if additional typhoons occur.
- Singapore congestion fell 3.3% WoW to 123.4 vessels in W32. The overall easing trend since the W26 peak continued, reducing congestion pressure.

[Port Congestion]⁶

(Unit : Vessels)

Region	Ports	2026							
		W25	W26	W27	W28	W29	W30	W31	W32
N.America	Long Beach	23.2	25.9	24.6	27.4	26.9	23.4	19.1	25.3
	New York	15.4	13.4	13.5	13.4	13.6	12.3	12.6	12.3
Europe	Rotterdam	61.4	62.4	67.6	59.9	63.5	62.3	58.5	55.3
	Hamburg	39.2	39.3	39.3	38.5	41.2	40.7	36.9	40.1
Asia	Shanghai	166.8	171.2	171.4	142.8	180.0	219.6	217.7	154.1
	Singapore	126.3	140.5	125.6	136.9	135.7	123.5	127.6	123.4

※ Outer Port In~Berth Out Average Count

⁵ Sea-Intelligence

⁶ Samsung SDS Cello Tracking



3. Ocean Freight Index Trends & Outlook

SCFI Trends

- The SCFI Comprehensive Index rose 5.1% MoM in July and 2.2% WoW in W32, led by USWC and USEC GRIs and carrier capacity management.
- USWC rates rose 13.4% MoM in July and 4.1% WoW in W32. Tariff-driven inventory replenishment and capacity control supported GRIs, while China typhoons constrained available capacity.
- USEC rates rose 26.7% MoM in July and 2.6% WoW in W32. GRIs and carrier capacity management kept rates elevated, while Chinese port disruptions and Panama operational risks increased supply uncertainty.
- N. Europe rates rose 6.2% MoM in July but fell 2.4% WoW in W32, marking a fifth consecutive weekly correction. Lower peak-season volumes and new capacity additions continued to weigh on rates.
- Middle East rates fell 4.8% MoM in July but rose 7.4% WoW in W32, extending gains for a fourth consecutive week. Hormuz transit uncertainty and higher carrier fuel and emergency surcharges drove the recent rebound.

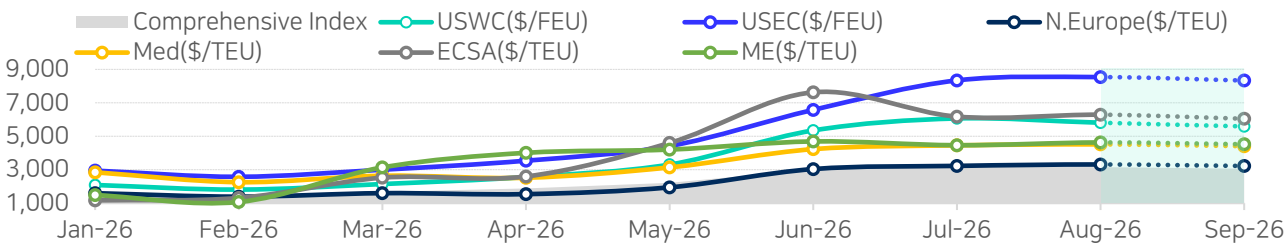
[SCFI Trends]⁷

Route	2026							Jul(Avg.)		
	W27	W28	W29	W30	W31	W32	%WoW		%MoM	%YoY
Comprehensive Index	3,327	3,185	3,080	3,063	3,206	3,276	2.2%	3,172	5.1%	88.4%
USWC(\$/FEU)	6,630	6,219	5,721	5,535	6,229	6,484	4.1%	6,067	13.4%	185.8%
USEC(\$/FEU)	8,296	8,134	8,172	8,040	9,054	9,290	2.6%	8,339	26.7%	118.2%
N.Europe(\$/TEU)	3,418	3,332	3,215	3,155	3,039	2,964	-2.4%	3,232	6.2%	54.5%
Med(\$/TEU)	4,717	4,561	4,475	4,351	4,189	4,048	-3.4%	4,459	5.3%	70.1%
ECSA(\$/TEU)	7,230	6,570	5,900	5,453	5,730	6,238	8.9%	6,177	-19.0%	5.5%
ME(\$/TEU)	4,392	4,199	4,266	4,584	4,894	5,258	7.4%	4,467	-4.8%	198.0%

Samsung SDS Short-term Forecast

- The SCFI Comprehensive Index is expected to be supported by US GRIs, capacity management, China typhoon disruptions, and Middle East risks. However, weaker European demand and capacity growth may lead to correction.
- USWC rates are expected to gain near-term support from inventory replenishment and capacity management amid tariff uncertainty. Rates may readjust as ports normalize or demand and capacity management weaken.
- USEC rates are expected to remain high, supported by capacity management and China-origin schedule disruptions. Panama draft and transit restrictions may constrain supply, keeping rates above USWC.
- N. Europe rates may remain flat or correct amid lower peak-season volumes and new capacity. Capacity management and Cape diversions may absorb capacity, limiting the correction.
- Middle East rates may remain highly volatile in August as continued Hormuz tensions increase cost burdens and constrain supply.

[Samsung SDS SCFI Forecast]⁸



⁷ Shanghai Shipping Exchange

⁸ Samsung SDS Brightics

If you are a Cello Square member,
Logistics Market Intelligence Reports analyzed by
Samsung SDS experts will be provided for free!

[Go to Logistics Market Intelligence Report](#)

Click here to download various Logistics Market Intelligence Reports by Samsung SDS

Daily News



Daily
Latest key news on
ocean and air freight

Monthly Report



Monthly
Key market trends and
updates on ocean and
air freight

Special Report



On Demand
In-depth reports focused
on specific topics

At Cello Square, The Trump administration's tariff
policy can also be seen at a glance!

[Go to Market Update](#)

Cello Square

Transportation Warehousing & Distribution Technology

Resources Support Company

Home > Resources > **Market Updates**



Market Intelligence

U.S. Tariff Policy: A Quick Overview

Registration date | JUN 02, 2026

Tariff Summary by Country

Category	date	Details of Tariff Policies
		USTR Announces Plan to Impose Additional Tariffs Under Section 301 on 60 Economies Over Forced Labor Concerns - USTR determined that insufficient import restrictions and enforcement against goods produced with forced labor in certain economies have contributed to circumvention and unfair competition for U.S. companies, and is moving to impose tariffs under Section 301 of the Trade Act - Additional tariffs will be applied at different rates by dividing the economies into two groups

This report has been prepared for informational purposes only and is current as of the date of provision. The information presented may change over time and should not be considered as a substitute for advice or other professional opinions when making business decisions.

As such, we disclaim any liability for any loss or damage arising out of the use of this report, regardless of the country in which it occurs. All responsibilities for the use and utilization of this report rest solely with the user, and we assume no obligation or responsibility for its contents.

Furthermore, the materials contained within this report may not be reproduced in any form or by any means without prior written consent. Should you wish to use part or all of the report materials, please direct your inquiries to cellosquare@samsung.com.

 www.cello-square.com



 cellosquare@samsung.com

 youtube.com/samsungsds



Digital logistics platform Cello Square

Offers differentiated digital logistics services powered by Samsung SDS's IT expertise and top-20 global logistics operations capabilities

www.cello-square.com